CPF Investment Scheme: what you need to know about CPFIS

Learn more about investing your CPF savings with CPFIS.

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IN A NUTSHELL:

- The CPFIS lets you invest your CPF savings in different products with varying risks and returns.
- It is important to consider factors such as your investment goals, investment horizon, risk tolerance level, risk-return trade off, diversification, and investments charges when deciding to invest with CPFIS.
- You can also leave your CPF savings in your respective CPF accounts to grow steadily with stable, risk-free interest.

If you are interested to explore other ways to grow your CPF savings beyond making top-ups to your CPF account, the CPF Investment Scheme (CPFIS) allows you to invest part of your CPF savings in a variety of investment products that come with varying levels of risk and return.

Invest your CPF savings with CPFIS >

What is CPFIS

CPFIS allows you to invest your Ordinary Account (OA) and Special Account (SA) savings in a range of approved financial products to achieve potentially higher expected returns than CPF interest rates and grow your retirement savings further, if you are willing to take some risk.

The scheme consists of two components: CPF Investment Scheme-Ordinary Account (CPFIS-OA) and CPF Investment Scheme-Special Account (CPFIS-SA).

Through CPFIS, you have the flexibility to tailor your investment strategy depending on your risk tolerance by investing in a wide range of financial products such as shares, unit trusts, government bonds, and Treasury Bills (T-bills).

Since its introduction in 1986, the CPFIS scheme has expanded from a limited range of products to include unit trusts, shares, bonds, exchange traded funds, gold products and other instruments, providing members with quality and low-cost investment options.

The scheme has been continuously enhanced over the years to include tighter fund admission criteria, lower cost of investing (e.g. removed sales charges and lowered expense ratios and wrap fees), and imposed a mandatory Self-Awareness Questionnaire (SAQ). This has helped members to make informed decisions and drive down the cost of investing. As of 30 Sep 2025, $21.4 billion of OA and SA savings are held in investments made by CPF members.

TIP

All investments come with risk. It is possible to lose some or even all the money you put in. Before investing, learn more about the three important principles of investing. Not all investments make money, including those included under the CPF Investment Scheme (CPFIS). The CPF Board does not endorse any specific investment products or providers in the CPFIS.

How to invest with CPFIS

Before investing with CPFIS, ensure that you meet the CPFIS eligibility criteria below:

CPFIS Eligibility Criteria

You can invest under CPFIS if you:

- Are at least 18 years old
- Are not an undischarged bankrupt
- Have more than $20,000 in your Ordinary Account (OA); and/or
- Have more than $40,000 in your Special Account (SA); and
- Have completed the Self-Awareness Questionnaire (SAQ).

CPFIS-OA

To invest your OA savings, you will need to open a CPF Investment Account with one of the following CPFIS agent banks:

- DBS's website
- OCBC's website or OCBC's mobile app
- UOB's website

CPFIS-SA

There is no need to open a CPF Investment Account to invest your SA savings. You can approach the product providers directly to buy or sell your investments.

TIP

Your CPF interest is computed monthly, then credited to your CPF accounts the following year. This means transactions in your accounts can affect the CPF balances used for interest computation.

When you sell your CPFIS-OA investment or when it matures, it is advisable to transfer the funds from your CPF Investment Account back to your CPF savings accounts if you do not intend to reinvest, to earn the CPF interest.

Amount of CPF savings that can be used for investment

You can invest your OA savings after setting aside $20,000 in your OA. Additionally, you can invest up to 35% and 10% of your investible savings in stocks and gold respectively.

For CPFIS-SA, you can invest your SA savings after setting aside $40,000 in your SA.

Key considerations when investing with CPFIS

1. Investment goal and horizon

First, start with your investment goal.

Your goal will help determine your investment horizon, which is the time frame you plan to commit the invested money. A long-term investment horizon will allow you to better ride out market volatility. This matters because all investments need time to grow and there is no get-rich-quick scheme.

In general, the longer your investment time horizon, the higher risk you may be able to take as you can afford to ride out the ups and downs of the market.

If you are investing your CPF savings, you should consider investing for the long term as these are your retirement savings.

2. Risk/return trade-off

You should make prudent investment choices that are in line with your retirement needs, which includes understanding your risk appetite. Everyone has a different level of risk tolerance, depending on factors such as age and income.

Historically, safer investments offer lower investment returns. On the other hand, higher-risk investments such as shares-related products can provide potentially higher returns. An important point to note is that investing in higher-risk investments does not guarantee higher returns. This is because while there's potential for larger gains, there's also a corresponding possibility of significant losses.

When making investment decisions, including under CPFIS, you should first understand the risk involved before aligning your investment choices with your risk tolerance and financial situation.

TIP

Your CPF savings offer stable interest that works behind the scenes to help secure your retirement. If you are unsure about investing, leave your funds in your CPF accounts to grow with the risk-free CPF interest rates and power of compound interest instead.

3. Cost of investment

There might also be additional costs such as brokerage and transaction fees that apply when you invest with your CPFIS. This can affect your total returns, so it's important to factor in these costs as well. Examples of some fees are:

Fee category	Estimated cost	Note
Wrap Fee	Cap of 0.4% per annum, charged over your fund portfolio value	An annual fee charged by financial advisors or platforms for bundled investment services, including portfolio management, administration, and advice.

	risk categories of funds, charged over the fund's net asset value	administrative fees, management fees, audit fees, legal fees and other operational costs.
Broker's Commission	0.25%-0.28% of exchange-traded product trade amount with minimum charge of $25 per transaction	Transactional fee charged for buying or selling exchange-traded products like shares, real estate investment trusts (REITS), exchange traded funds, corporate bonds, Statutory Board Bonds, gold exchange traded funds, Singapore Government Bonds, Treasury Bills.

What you can invest with CPFIS

The CPFIS lets you invest in a wide range of financial products with varying risks. Here are some that you can consider starting with:

Treasury Bills (T-bills)

T-bills are short-term Government bills that mature in one year or less from their issue date. The Government currently offers 6-month and 1-year T-bills. They are issued at a discount to their face value. When the T-bills mature, the Government pays the holder an amount of money equivalent to its face value.

Singapore Government Securities (SGS) Bonds

SGS bonds are debt securities issued by the Singapore Government. The bonds are longer-term bonds which mature in 2, 5, 10, 15, 20, 30, or 50 years.

SGS bond holders receive fixed coupon payments every six months before the bond matures and the face value of the bond upon maturity.

An important thing to note is that while these bonds are of a longer duration, you might stand to lose your capital if you do not hold the bonds till maturity. This is because the bonds are subject to price fluctuations due to interest rate changes and market movements.

Fixed deposits

Fixed deposits lock in your money with a bank or financial institution for a set tenure. During this tenure, the institution offers a guaranteed interest rate, and at the end of the tenure, you will receive the initial amount plus earned interest. Early withdrawal may incur fees or penalties, so it's advisable to ensure you have enough funds for daily needs.

Fixed deposits are guaranteed by banks or financial institutions. However, in the event that they fail, it's worth noting that the Singapore Deposit Insurance Corporation Limited (SDIC) insures bank deposits up to $100,000.

Exchange Traded Funds (ETFs)

Exchange-Traded Funds (ETFs) are investment funds that are listed and traded on a stock exchange. Your investment is pooled with those of other investors and invested according to the objective of the particular ETF. This can range from tracking a particular index, such as the Straits Times Index that tracks the performance of the top 30 leading companies in the Singapore Exchange, or an index that tracks the price of commodities such as gold.

Should you invest your CPF savings with CPFIS?

Generally, you should only invest your CPF savings if you:

- Can afford the risk of losing part, or all of your investments.

- Have sufficient funds beyond your basic retirement needs.
- Have the time and financial expertise to monitor your investments regularly so that they can outperform the risk-free CPF interest rates.

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You don't have to feel left out if you choose not to invest your CPF savings. Your CPF savings will continue to grow steadily over time with the stable, risk-free interest rates.

Information in this article is accurate as at the date of publication.

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